

E-mail template

Dear **XXX**,

My name is [XXX], and I am a researcher at the School of Geography, Earth and Environmental Sciences, University of Birmingham. I am conducting a study on the structural robustness of global land use and hydrological models, with a focus on how software architecture relates to model stability and maintenance risk.

We have developed a network-based analysis of [**the model**]'s call graph and we would like to compare our results with the experience of those involved in the code and know it best.

The questionnaire takes under twenty minutes. It focuses on a small set of functions and call sequences that you may be familiar with, and asks you to assess (i) how critical they are in practice, (ii) how error-prone or hard to maintain they feel, and (iii) whether you would prioritise them for refactoring or additional testing.

If you know of another maintainer of either this model or another global land use / hydrological models who would be well placed to comment on these parts of the code, we would be grateful if you could forward this message or share their contact details.

Questionnaire link: [LINK TO THE QUESTIONNAIRE]

After you submit the form, please contact [XXX] citing that you have completed this survey and which model you are associated with if you would like to receive a short summary with the structural metrics we have computed on your model's code and structure, and a short summary comparing your assessments with our results. This summary will be sent once this survey has closed and we have analysed the results.

We hope you find this opportunity interesting and we thank you very much for your time. Please do not hesitate to contact me if you would like any clarification.

Best regards,

[XXX]

University of Birmingham